

Software Licenses -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit tp-3.3 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 3.3 | N10-008 FC0-U71 3.3

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Question 1

A software _____ is a legal agreement that grants users permission to use software under specific conditions. Without a license, using software is _____ infringement. An _____ (End User License Agreement) is the license document users must accept before installation.

Answer: License; copyright; EULA.

Question 2

A _____ license allows software to be installed on one computer or used by one named user. A _____ license allows any number of users within an organization to use the software. A _____ license is tied to a specific device rather than a specific user.

Answer: Per-seat (single-user); enterprise (volume); per-device.

Question 3

Open source licenses allow users to freely use, modify, and often _____ software. The GPL (GNU General Public License) requires that any derivative work also be released under the _____ license -- this is called _____ licensing. The MIT license is more _____, allowing use in proprietary products.

Answer: Redistribute; GPL (same open source); copyleft; permissive.

Question 4

_____ is software in the public domain -- copyright has expired or been waived -- and anyone can use it without a license. _____ software is free to distribute but may restrict modification or commercial use. _____ software is commercial software that users can try before buying, often with limited features or a time limit.

Answer: Public domain; freeware; shareware (trial).

Question 5

A subscription license requires periodic _____ payments to maintain access. Examples include Microsoft 365 and Adobe Creative Cloud. If the subscription _____, access to the software is typically revoked. The advantage for vendors is _____ revenue; the advantage for users is always receiving _____ updates.

Answer: Recurring; expires (lapses); recurring (predictable); the latest (current).

Question 6

Concurrent (floating) licenses allow a defined number of _____ simultaneous users, regardless of how many total users are licensed. If all _____ are in use, additional users must _____ until a license is released. This model is efficient for software used occasionally by many people.

Answer: Maximum; seats (licenses); wait.

Question 7

Software _____ is the illegal copying, distribution, or use of software beyond the terms of its license. Common violations include installing one licensed copy on _____ computers, sharing license _____ online, and using cracked software. Penalties include _____ fines and civil lawsuits.

Answer: Piracy; multiple; keys; financial.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A business of 25 employees uses Microsoft Office. They currently own 5 retail boxed copies installed on several shared computers. Employees complain they cannot access Word on their own machines. The IT admin wants to fix this. Describe the most appropriate licensing model for this business and how it differs from what they currently have.

Answer: The business should purchase a Microsoft 365 Business subscription (subscription/per-seat model). Currently they have 5 retail perpetual licenses tied to specific devices -- only users at those 5 machines can use Office. Microsoft 365 Business licenses each user (per-seat), so each of the 25 employees gets a named license that allows them to install Office on up to 5 of their own devices (PC, Mac, tablet, phone). Benefits: all 25 employees have access from their own devices; licenses are managed centrally in the Microsoft admin portal; the business always has the latest version; licenses can be added or removed as staff changes. This replaces the inefficient shared-device model and eliminates compliance risk from overuse.